



CAREERSENSE ACADEMY

UI/UX Design with Figma

User journeys, wireframes, design systems, prototypes, accessibility, usability testing, and developer handoff

PARTNER LEARNING SERIES

Learn a practical UX workflow from understanding users to designing interfaces, testing prototypes, building reusable systems, and handing designs to developers.

CareerSense Partners • aspiring designers • product managers • developers • founders

CareerSense Learning Series • careersenseai.com/resources

FRONT MATTER

How to Use This Handbook

Learn a practical UX workflow from understanding users to designing interfaces, testing prototypes, building reusable systems, and handing designs to developers.

What each chapter contains

Each chapter follows the same learning rhythm used across the CareerSense Academy series: a concise introduction, learning objectives, plain-English concepts, CareerSense examples, professional habits, common mistakes, quick revision notes, practice questions, and hands-on exercises.

PARTNER PROMISE The examples are designed to prepare you for real CareerSense Partner assignments. Do not memorize terminology. Learn to create useful work products: audits, reports, prototypes, dashboards, campaigns, strategies, and decisions.

Recommended practice approach

- Read the relevant chapter before starting the matching Partner assignment.
- Use CareerSense or a safe sample environment to practise whenever possible.
- Keep evidence: screenshots, notes, links, spreadsheets, queries, designs, or metrics.
- Document assumptions and limitations instead of hiding uncertainty.
- Finish each chapter by completing at least one hands-on exercise.

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What You Will Learn

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02	Research, Personas, and User Journeys
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07	Usability Testing and Accessibility
08	CareerSense Capstone: UX Rescue

Closing the book: quick revision sheet • glossary • professional habits • 20-question quiz • answer key • next steps.

CHAPTER 01

01

UX Foundations and Human-Centered Design

User experience is the total experience of accomplishing a goal with a product. UI is the visual and interactive layer that supports that experience.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Define UX and UI
- Recognize user goals
- Understand mental models
- Separate aesthetics from usability

Core idea

User experience is the total experience of accomplishing a goal with a product. UI is the visual and interactive layer that supports that experience.

Professional perspective

Beautiful screens cannot compensate for unclear information architecture or broken task flows.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

A CareerSense ATS report should help the user understand what to do next, not only display a visually impressive score.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Define UX and UI.
- Recognize user goals.
- Understand mental models.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of ux foundations and human-centered design?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to ux foundations and human-centered design using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 02

02

Research, Personas, and User Journeys

Journey maps show stages, goals, actions, emotions, questions, and friction across an experience.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Create lightweight personas
- Map journeys
- Identify pain points
- Define moments that matter

Core idea

Journey maps show stages, goals, actions, emotions, questions, and friction across an experience.

Professional perspective

Personas should be evidence-based representations of behavior and needs, not fictional demographics.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Map the journey from a student's first CareerSense visit to completing a resume, interview simulation, and career plan.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Create lightweight personas.
- Map journeys.
- Identify pain points.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of research, personas, and user journeys?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to research, personas, and user journeys using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 03

03

Information Architecture and Flows

Information architecture decides how content and capabilities are grouped and found. Task flows show the sequence required to achieve a goal.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Organize navigation
- Create task flows
- Reduce cognitive load
- Use progressive disclosure

Core idea

Information architecture decides how content and capabilities are grouped and found. Task flows show the sequence required to achieve a goal.

Professional perspective

Progressive disclosure reveals complexity only when it becomes relevant.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

CareerSense should not overwhelm a new user with every tool at once; prioritize next best actions based on profile and readiness.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

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QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Organize navigation.
- Create task flows.
- Reduce cognitive load.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of information architecture and flows?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to information architecture and flows using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 04

04

Wireframing in Figma

Wireframes focus discussion on structure before visual polish. Use clear hierarchy, realistic content lengths, states, and navigation.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Create low-fidelity screens
- Use grids and hierarchy
- Design responsive structures
- Annotate flows

Core idea

Wireframes focus discussion on structure before visual polish. Use clear hierarchy, realistic content lengths, states, and navigation.

Professional perspective

Design multiple breakpoints when information density changes substantially.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Redesign a CareerSense dashboard in low fidelity before applying color, imagery, or detailed components.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Create low-fidelity screens.
- Use grids and hierarchy.
- Design responsive structures.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of wireframing in figma?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to wireframing in figma using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 05

05

Visual Design and Design Systems

Design systems codify reusable patterns for color, type, spacing, components, interaction states, and accessibility.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Use typography and spacing systems
- Create components
- Define states
- Maintain consistency

Core idea

Design systems codify reusable patterns for color, type, spacing, components, interaction states, and accessibility.

Professional perspective

Components reduce drift and make product changes faster.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Create CareerSense button, card, form, badge, alert, progress, and navigation components with states.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Use typography and spacing systems.
- Create components.
- Define states.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of visual design and design systems?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to visual design and design systems using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 06

06

Prototyping and Interaction

Prototypes should answer questions. High-fidelity motion is useful only when it helps validate an interaction.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Build clickable prototypes
- Choose transitions intentionally
- Represent loading and errors
- Test realistic flows

Core idea

Prototypes should answer questions. High-fidelity motion is useful only when it helps validate an interaction.

Professional perspective

Represent empty, loading, success, and error states rather than only the ideal path.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Prototype the complete partner application and onboarding flow, including validation and confirmation.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Build clickable prototypes.
- Choose transitions intentionally.
- Represent loading and errors.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of prototyping and interaction?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to prototyping and interaction using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 07

07

Usability Testing and Accessibility

Usability testing asks people to perform realistic tasks while designers observe where expectations and interfaces diverge.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Plan usability tasks
- Observe without coaching
- Synthesize issues
- Apply accessibility checks

Core idea

Usability testing asks people to perform realistic tasks while designers observe where expectations and interfaces diverge.

Professional perspective

Accessibility checks include contrast, keyboard navigation, text alternatives, labels, focus states, and readable hierarchy.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Test whether a user can find their ATS report, interpret it, and act on recommendations without explanation.

Practice lens	What it means
Weak approach	Start with activity or opinion without defining the desired outcome.
Professional approach	Define the decision, evidence, owner, success measure, and next action.
Evidence to keep	Notes, screenshots, metrics, links, artifacts, or stakeholder feedback.

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Plan usability tasks.
- Observe without coaching.
- Synthesize issues.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

Q1 What is the main purpose of usability testing and accessibility?

Q2 How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?

Q3 What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?

Q4 What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to usability testing and accessibility using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CHAPTER 08

08

CareerSense Capstone: UX Rescue

Choose one CareerSense workflow and redesign it using evidence. Include heuristic audit, journey, wireframes, design-system components, high-fidelity prototype, usability feedback, and handoff notes.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Audit an existing workflow
- Create before/after journeys
- Design a Figma prototype
- Present rationale

Core idea

Choose one CareerSense workflow and redesign it using evidence. Include heuristic audit, journey, wireframes, design-system components, high-fidelity prototype, usability feedback, and handoff notes.

CAREERSENSE CONNECTION

Deliver the Figma link plus a concise UX case study.

Practice lens	What it means
Question to ask	What user or business problem are we trying to solve?
Risk to test	What assumption could make this work fail or produce little value?
Completion signal	What observable result proves the assignment is done well?

COMMON MISTAKE

Producing a polished artifact without showing the evidence, assumptions, decision logic, and measurable outcome behind it.

QUICK REVISION NOTES

- Audit an existing workflow.
- Create before/after journeys.
- Design a Figma prototype.
- Tie recommendations to evidence and expected impact.
- Communicate constraints and uncertainty clearly.

Practice Questions

- Q1** What is the main purpose of careersense capstone: ux rescue?
- Q2** How would you apply this topic to a CareerSense Partner assignment?
- Q3** What evidence would you collect before making a recommendation?
- Q4** What is one common mistake a beginner should avoid?

Hands-on Exercises

- 1 Create a one-page working artifact related to careersense capstone: ux rescue using CareerSense or a safe sample scenario.
- 2 Review your artifact as if you were a startup leader: identify one missing assumption, one risk, and one measurable improvement.
- 3 Write a 150-word executive summary explaining what you found and what should happen next.

CLOSING THE BOOK

Course Summary

You have worked through the professional foundations of ui/ux design with figma. The purpose of this handbook is not to make you fluent in vocabulary; it is to help you complete real work with stronger judgment, structure, evidence, and communication.

**PROFESSIONAL
TAKEAWAY**

CareerSense Partners should be able to explain not only what they did, but why it mattered, what evidence supported it, what trade-offs existed, and what measurable action should happen next.

UI/UX Design with Figma - Quick Revision Sheet

Topic	Remember
UX Foundations and Human-Centered Design	Define UX and UI
Research, Personas, and User Journeys	Create lightweight personas
Information Architecture and Flows	Organize navigation
Wireframing in Figma	Create low-fidelity screens
Visual Design and Design Systems	Use typography and spacing systems
Prototyping and Interaction	Build clickable prototypes
Usability Testing and Accessibility	Plan usability tasks
CareerSense Capstone: UX Rescue	Audit an existing workflow

Glossary

Term	Plain-English meaning
Wireframe	A low-fidelity representation of screen structure.
Prototype	An interactive representation used to test a design.
Design system	Reusable visual and interaction standards and components.
Outcome	A measurable change in user, customer, or business behavior.
Metric	A quantitative measure used to monitor performance or progress.
Hypothesis	A testable statement about what change is expected and why.
Stakeholder	A person or group affected by or able to influence an initiative.
MVP	The smallest trustworthy version that tests an important assumption.
KPI	A key performance indicator tied to an important objective.
Iteration	A cycle of building, measuring, learning, and improving.
Trade-off	Choosing one benefit or priority while accepting a cost elsewhere.
Evidence	Observed information that supports or challenges a decision.
Prioritization	Deciding what deserves attention and resources first.

20-Question Practice Quiz

1. What is one core principle from 'UX Foundations and Human-Centered Design'?
9. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'UX Foundations and Human-Centered Design' in a real assignment?
2. What is one core principle from 'Research, Personas, and User Journeys'?
10. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Research, Personas, and User Journeys' in a real assignment?
3. What is one core principle from 'Information Architecture and Flows'?
11. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Information Architecture and Flows' in a real assignment?
4. What is one core principle from 'Wireframing in Figma'?
12. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Wireframing in Figma' in a real assignment?
5. What is one core principle from 'Visual Design and Design Systems'?
13. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Visual Design and Design Systems' in a real assignment?
6. What is one core principle from 'Prototyping and Interaction'?
14. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Prototyping and Interaction' in a real assignment?
7. What is one core principle from 'Usability Testing and Accessibility'?
15. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'Usability Testing and Accessibility' in a real assignment?
8. What is one core principle from 'CareerSense Capstone: UX Rescue'?
16. How could a CareerSense Partner apply 'CareerSense Capstone: UX Rescue' in a real assignment?
17. Why should recommendations be tied to evidence?
18. What is the difference between an activity and an outcome?
19. Why should assumptions and limitations be documented?
20. What makes an assignment deliverable useful to leadership?

Answer Key

1. A strong answer should explain define ux and ui and connect it to an observable decision or result.
9. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
2. A strong answer should explain create lightweight personas and connect it to an observable decision or result.
10. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
3. A strong answer should explain organize navigation and connect it to an observable decision or result.
11. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
4. A strong answer should explain create low-fidelity screens and connect it to an observable decision or result.
12. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
5. A strong answer should explain use typography and spacing systems and connect it to an observable decision or result.
13. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
6. A strong answer should explain build clickable prototypes and connect it to an observable decision or result.
14. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
7. A strong answer should explain plan usability tasks and connect it to an observable decision or result.
15. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
8. A strong answer should explain audit an existing workflow and connect it to an observable decision or result.
16. Apply the concept using a specific CareerSense workflow, evidence, deliverable, and measurable outcome.
17. Evidence separates a useful recommendation from an unsupported opinion.
18. An activity is work performed; an outcome is the change produced by that work.
19. Documenting assumptions makes uncertainty visible and allows reviewers to judge the strength of the conclusion.
20. A useful deliverable is clear, evidence-based, actionable, appropriately scoped, and tied to an owner or next decision.

CAREERSENSE ACADEMY

Keep Building

You now have a working foundation in ui/ux design with figma. Use this handbook as a reference before and during your Partner assignments. Professional capability grows when you repeatedly turn concepts into useful outputs, receive feedback, and improve your judgment.

NEXT STEPS

- Choose the CareerSense Partner assignment most closely related to this handbook.
- Review the relevant chapter before beginning.
- Complete the assignment with traceable evidence.
- Ask for feedback on both the result and your decision process.
- Add the finished work to your Partner portfolio where permitted.

**CAREERSENSE
PARTNER
LEARNING PATH**

Learn → Apply → Document → Review → Improve → Lead.

More CareerSense learning resources

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